

INDIA'S COMMITMENTS

■ Separating its civilian nuclear plants from its military ones in phases.



■ Negotiating an India specific safeguards agreement with IAEA.



■ Harmonising its export controls with NSG and MTCR guidelines.



■ Continuing to observe its unilateral moratorium on testing.



■ Negotiate the Fissile Material Cutoff Treaty.



AMERICA'S PROMISES

■ Get US Congress to amend its laws to allow civil nuclear commerce.



■ Get the 45-member NSG to give a waiver to India for trade.



■ Get India involved in the ITER project for thermonuclear energy.



■ Provide India fuel supply assurances for reactors it imports from US.



■ Sell enrichment and reprocessing technology.



THE FUTURE

■ The deal allows India to immediately negotiate with all NSG countries to provide fuel for its reactors it designates as civilians and puts under safeguards.

■ India will now import nuclear reactors and sensitive technology for reprocessing and enrichment from a host of countries.

■ It can pursue its nuclear weapons programme without any hitches. But will face serious consequences if it conducts a test in future.

India can now formally begin trade in civilian nuclear technology while continuing to develop its weapons

JULY 27, 2007

THE 123 AGREEMENT IS

initialled by the US and India outlining how they would conduct civilian nuclear trade.

AUGUST 1, 2008

IAEA CLEARS INDIA-SPECIFIC

safeguards agreement that defines its level of supervision of civilian plants.

SEPTEMBER 6, 2008

NSG WAIVER COMES through after intense negotiations among its 45 members to allow nuclear trade with India.

OCTOBER 8, 2006

BUSH SIGNS THE ACT that makes the 123 Agreement as approved by the Congress into law in the US.

reasons than just bailing out India's flailing nuclear industry. India had become chronically short of energy—the power cuts that most cities experience is testimony to that. With an energy shortage of 10 per cent, India needs to add 10 power plants of 1,000 MW capacity this year alone to meet its current demand. It is still heavily dependent on thermal power fired mainly by coal to help ease the energy shortage. Thermal power now accounts for 51 per cent of the electricity generating capacity of 1,45,000 MW. But apart from dwindling coal reserves it comes with the disadvantage of high carbon emissions that will put India on the mat for global warming. Hydro-electric generation is credited with another 25 per cent but with envi-

ronmental activism and the damage to forest resources being enormous, they are not seen as the best alternative. In renewable energy, like solar and winds, efforts haven't met with the kind of success they should have and they now contribute barely 8 per cent of the share. Enter nuclear power.

Nuclear power is enjoying a remarkable comeback across the world—after major improvements in safety of reactors following Chernobyl and Three Mile Island—and is once again being touted as the clean fuel of the future. France is the leader with nuclear power accounting for 75 per cent of its electricity generation. Japan is at around 30 per cent. Even European countries like Germany, who are rethinking their opposition to nuclear plants, have

begun making enquiries. In the US, there has been a surge of interest—John McCain promised that if he became President he would sanction a hundred new nuclear plants. Nuclear energy now accounts for 23 per cent of the total world electricity production while in India it contributes only a paltry 3 per cent.

The deal is certain to change that. Soon after his New York and Washington visit, Manmohan flew into Paris for a bilateral summit with French President Nicolas Sarkozy. As they looked on, Anil Kakodkar, Atomic Energy Commission chairman and Bernard Kouchner, the French foreign minister, signed an umbrella Indo-French nuclear cooperation agreement. Details of it have still not been made public but from the